

focuses on oncology,” he says.

In India, affordability is a big challenge, as advanced therapies can cost lakhs. “Our biosimilar Sigrima, which replicates pertuzumab for HER2-positive breast cancer, allows patients to access treatment at a fraction of the original cost,” says Patel.

Zyklus is also expanding the clinical trial footprint. “India has a large and diverse patient population and cost-efficient trial operations. Yet oncology trials remain limited due to infrastructure gaps outside metros, late-stage diagnosis, shortages of trained investigators, and low research participation. We are conducting trials in biosimilars and targeted therapies to bring innovation to patients faster,” says Patel. Oncology contributes over 60% to Zyklus’s specialty business, driven by first-in-India biosimilar launches like T-DM1 and Pertuzumab.

Dr. Reddy’s Laboratories’ focus spans standard-of-care therapies and next-generation innovations. “Flagship products such as Reditux, Versavo, Lenangio, and Hervycta are now available across India, supporting treatment for multiple cancer types,” says a company spokesperson.

In 2024, the company launched Toripalimab, a next-generation PD-1 inhibitor, for nasopharyngeal carcinoma. “Toripalimab offers improved outcomes for patients with recurrent or metastatic NPC (nasopharyngeal carcinoma),” says the spokesperson.

Aurigene Oncology Ltd, a Dr. Reddy’s subsidiary, has reported promising Phase I results for DRL-1801, India’s first autologous BCMA-directed CAR-T therapy for relapsed or refractory multiple myeloma. It is a groundbreaking

...TRIGGERS INVESTMENT RUSH

HOSPITALS

COMPANY	COMMITTED / UPCOMING INVESTMENT	TIMELINE / EXPECTED COMPLETION
TATA TRUSTS’ ASSAM CANCER CARE FOUNDATION	₹2,200 crore	17 hospitals planned
APOLLO HOSPITALS	₹2,000 crore	2025–2028 (Tier-II/III expansion (mainly oncology + Gurugram proton therapy))
MANIPAL HOSPITALS	₹1,500 crore	2025–2028 (oncology-focused blocks, e.g., Bhubaneswar 100-bed cancer centre)
MAX HEALTHCARE	₹5,000 crore	2025–2028 (hospital expansion, including oncology services)
FORTIS HEALTHCARE	₹1,000 crore	2025–2028 (capacity and technology upgrades, including oncology)
HEALTHCARE GLOBAL	₹700 crore	2025–2026 (network expansion, research hubs)
ASTER DM HEALTHCARE	₹2,500 crore	Expansion, including cancer care over the next few years
OMEGA HOSPITALS	N/A	PE-backed expansion projects already under execution

DIAGNOSTICS

METROPOLIS HEALTHCARE	NA	2025–2026 (lab upgrades for oncology testing)
AGILUS DIAGNOSTICS	₹250 crore	2025–2027 (advanced molecular/pathology labs expansion)
DR LAL PATHLABS	Ongoing incremental investment	2025–2028 (high-complexity labs supporting oncology)

PHARMA / BIOLOGICS

SUN PHARMA	\$100 million (₹850 crore)	FY26 (specialty/oncology products commercialisation, including UNLOXCYT)
BIOCON / BIOCON BIOLOGICS	₹1,200 crore	2025–2027 (manufacturing expansion & global distribution of oncology biologics)